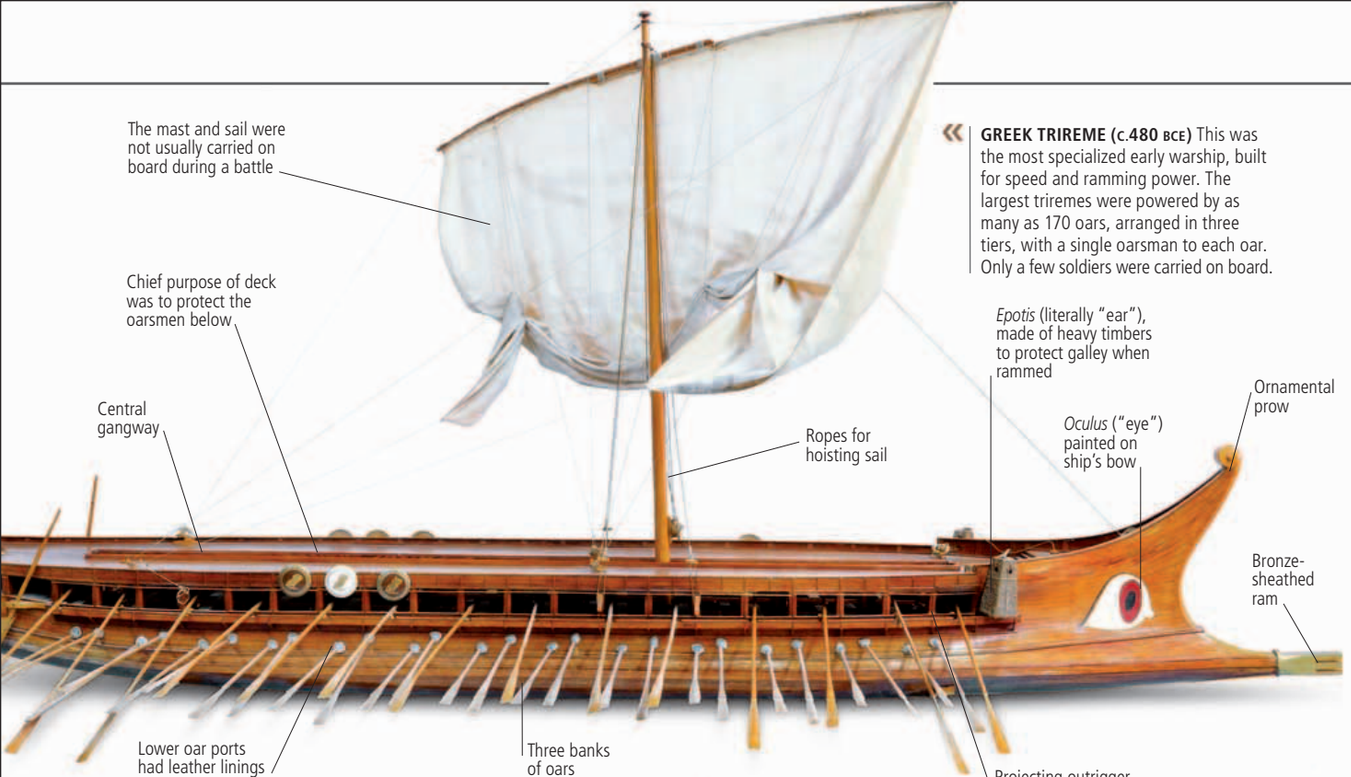
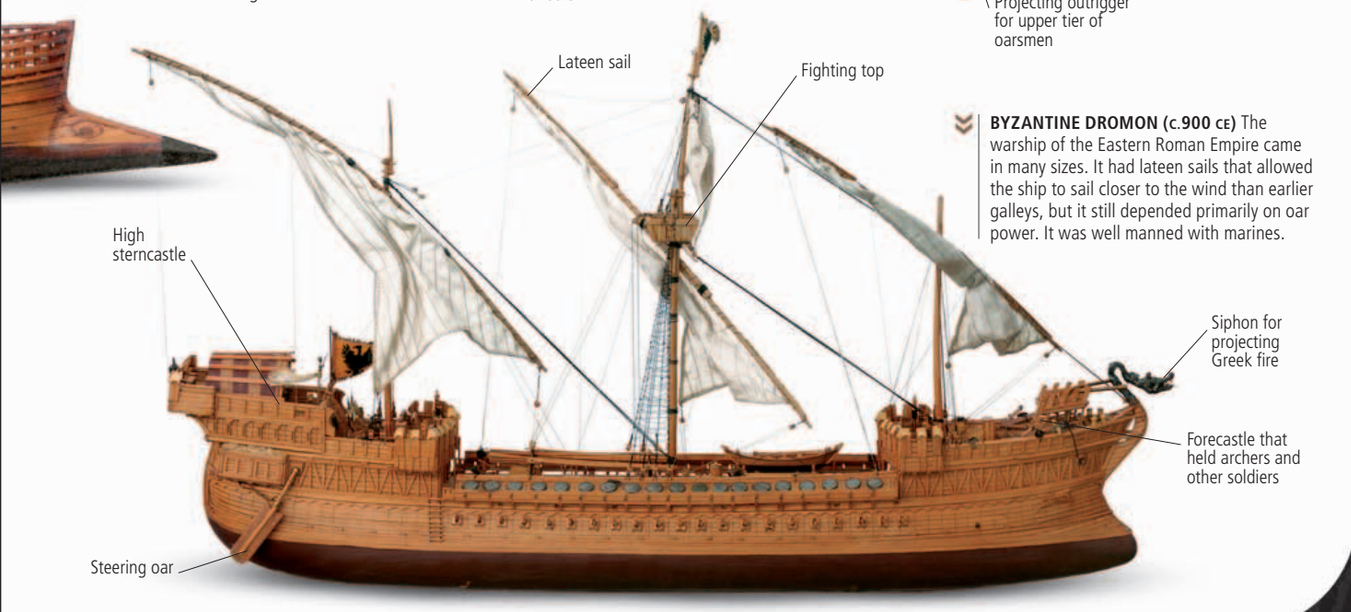


GREEK TRIREME (c.480 BCE) This was the most specialized early warship, built for speed and ramming power. The largest triremes were powered by as many as 170 oars, arranged in three tiers, with a single oarsman to each oar. Only a few soldiers were carried on board.



BYZANTINE DROMON (c.900 CE) The warship of the Eastern Roman Empire came in many sizes. It had lateen sails that allowed the ship to sail closer to the wind than earlier galleys, but it still depended primarily on oar power. It was well manned with marines.

GLOSSARY

An explanation of less familiar nautical and military terms used in the book is given below.

1ST RATE British ship of the line with more than 100 guns on three decks.
2ND RATE British ship of the line with 90–98 guns on three decks.
3RD RATE British ship of the line with 64–74 guns on two decks.
4TH RATE British ship of the line with 46–60 guns on two decks.
5TH RATE British frigate with 32–44 guns on a single deck.
6TH RATE Small British warship with 20–28 guns on a single deck, a small frigate.
AFT Toward the stern of the ship.
ARQUEBUS Early form of musket, used in 16th century.
ARPAX Roman mechanical device for grappling enemy ships.
ASTROLABE Nautical instrument used for measuring latitude.
BALINGER Small shallow-hulled English sailing barge of the late Middle Ages. Could be powered by oars as well as sail.
BALLISTA Roman catapult for firing iron-tipped bolts.
BALLISTIC MISSILE Medium- or long-range missile for delivering (usually nuclear) warhead. Powered initially by rocket fuel, the missile descends to its target in freefall.
BARBETTE Armored cylinder supporting the large gun turrets of 19th- and 20th-century warships.
BAR SHOT Cannon ammunition, consisting of two half-cannonballs linked by a solid bar. Used, like chain shot, for attacking spars and rigging of sailing ships.
BATTLECRUISER Class of heavily armed ship developed in years leading up to World War I as a kind of fast battleship.
BATTLEGROUP Formation of surface ships, originally centered on battleships, but in recent times consisting of a carrier with guided missile destroyers, anti-submarine destroyers, cruisers, and frigates.
BEAM The breadth of a ship at its widest point.
BILGE Lowest part of the interior of the hull, where water collects.
BINNACLE Mount for a ship's compass, in sailing ships usually sited on the quarterdeck.

